Art & *expression*

Personal art, participation and design explorations.

everyday experience



DETAIL / PERSONAL OIL PASTEL DRAWING

Likun Ma

ART / EXPRESSION / EVERYDAY EXPERIENCE

A reading journey.

01 Background & learning — 03-06
Likun Ma / I DO / FILA / courses

02 Personal art practice — 07-09
Faces / Oil pastel / Landscape

03 A story in six panels — 10-11
Workshop participation / My story

04 Expression leaves a trace — 12-16
TRACE / Sanctuary

05 A gesture becomes an experience — 17-20
Draw with Light / Wave Troubles Goodbye / Contentment

06 Material, environment & memory — 21-25
Ceramic Soundscape Module / Countenance / After Smile

07 Selected design explorations — 26-27
Cupping | Negative Pressure / LOVE NANJING

08 Reflection & further learning — 28-30
What connects the work / Why art therapy / Achievements

From spaces *to expression.*

Likun Ma

I am an independent designer with over twenty years of experience in spatial design, engineering and project management. This background has taught me to turn ideas into spaces and objects that people can use and experience.



I DO / NANNING / 2020

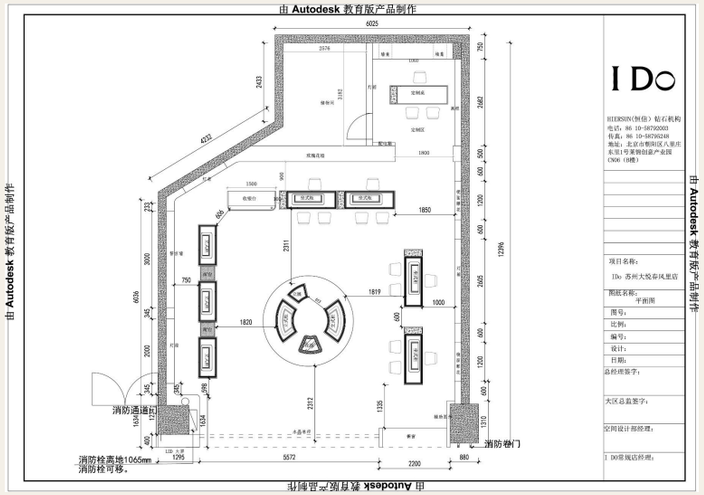
Today, I bring that experience to ceramics, jewellery, interaction and digital design. I focus on small moments in everyday life: a touch, a beam of light, or a moment spent recording a feeling.

Emotion, memory and perception.

I DO

HIERSUN / Nanning, China
In City Plaza / 2020

Light tones, soft surfaces and a central display organise the space around viewing and conversation. The plan shows how display, seating and circulation work together.



LAYOUT / DISPLAY / CIRCULATION



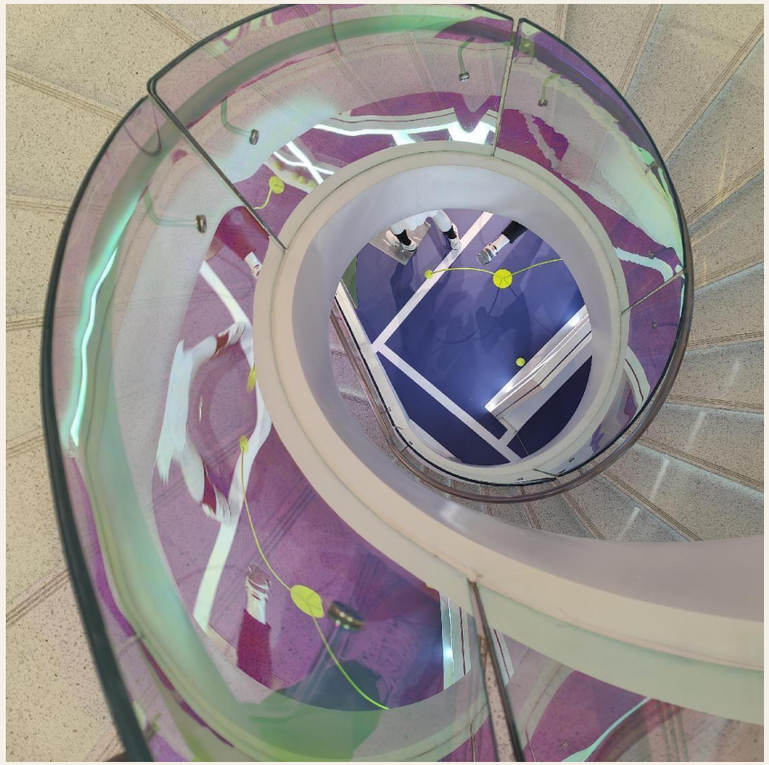


An early foundation in shaping experience through space.

2022 / 2023

FILA

Movement, light & display.



NANJING / DEJI PLAZA / 2022



TIANJIN / HISENSE PLAZA / 2023

These retail projects form part of my spatial and project experience. They show how circulation, lighting and display can be organised within a shared environment.





LIGHT / DISPLAY DETAILS

Learning *starts here.*

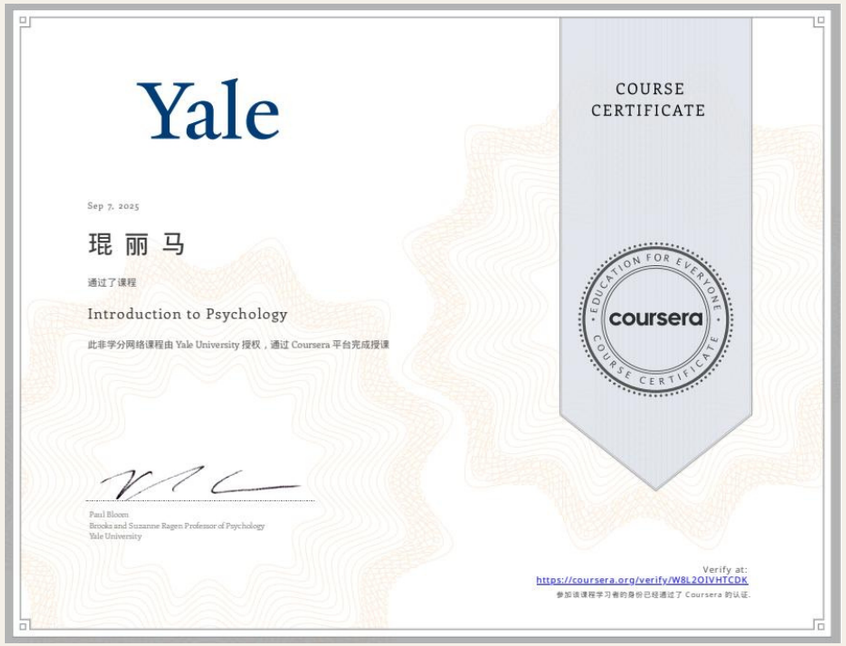
Introduction to Psychology

Yale University / Coursera
Completed 7 September 2025

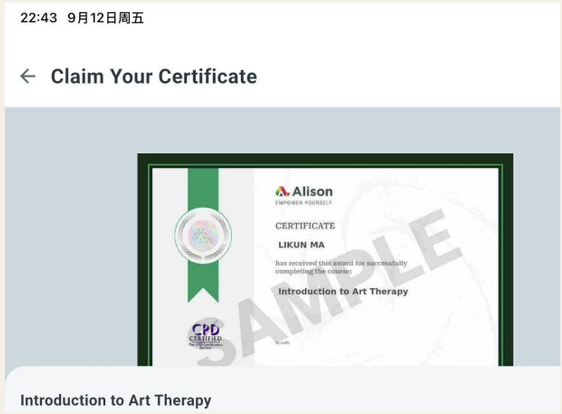
Introduction to Art Therapy

Alison / Course completed
Further study in colour psychology

These studies give me a starting point for asking how art, expression and human experience can be understood more deeply.



COURSE CERTIFICATE



COURSE COMPLETION SCREEN



01 / TRANSPARENT WATER-BASED COLOUR



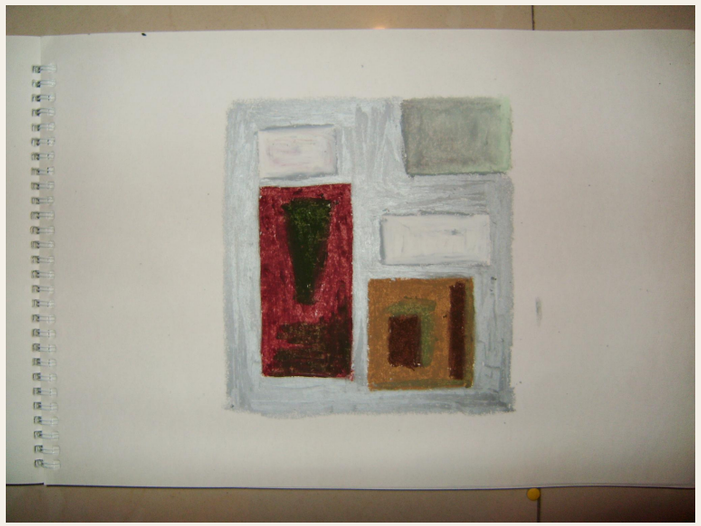
02 / TRANSPARENT WATER-BASED COLOUR

Faces *in colour.*

Personal paintings on paper.
Colour carries the face beyond a fixed outline.

Colour, *before words.*

Oil pastel drawings made
in response to my mood.



02 / COLOUR & STRUCTURE



01 / GESTURE & OVERLAPPING MARKS

Gesture, colour and material.

A place *on paper.*

A landscape painting
from my personal practice.

Light, foliage
and layered marks.



LANDSCAPE / PAINTING ON PAPER

Six prompts, *one story.*

I participated in an online art activity using six prompts to organise a story through drawing.

01 Character

02 Goal

03 Obstacle

04 Helper

05 Action

06 Outcome





WORKSHOP PROMPTS / PARTICIPANT RECORD

A flower, *against the weather.*



MY DRAWING / SIX-PANEL NARRATIVE

I chose a natural flower as the character, also representing a pure person. Its goal is to withstand harm and remain standing through the weather. The obstacle is the damage caused by reality.

Support is scarce and sometimes hidden, appearing when least expected. In the action frame, eyes become swords and the person faces them with their head held high.

The outcome belongs to time: a person holds a clock. Drawing lets me place the character, obstacles, support and action within one narrative.

TRACE

When words become form.

Language disappears.
Expression remains.



15

MINUTES OF EXPRESSION

LANGUAGE

01

COLLAPSE

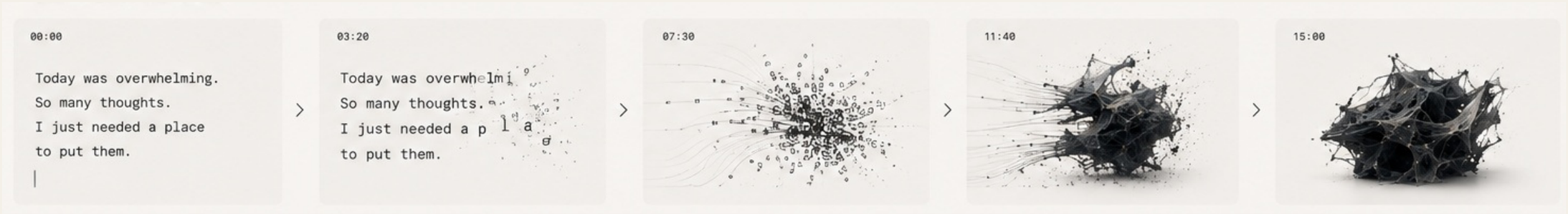
02

TRACE

03

BRONZE / INTERACTION DESIGN / 7TH SGADC

Fifteen minutes, *changing form.*



00:00 / 03:20 / 07:30 / 11:40 / 15:00

Readable words gradually lose their structure. The proposed sequence moves from language, through collapse, to a form that holds the trace of expression.

An act of expression can leave a form.

What remains?



Rhythm

Temporal patterns shape the surface.

Mass

The amount of input informs the form.

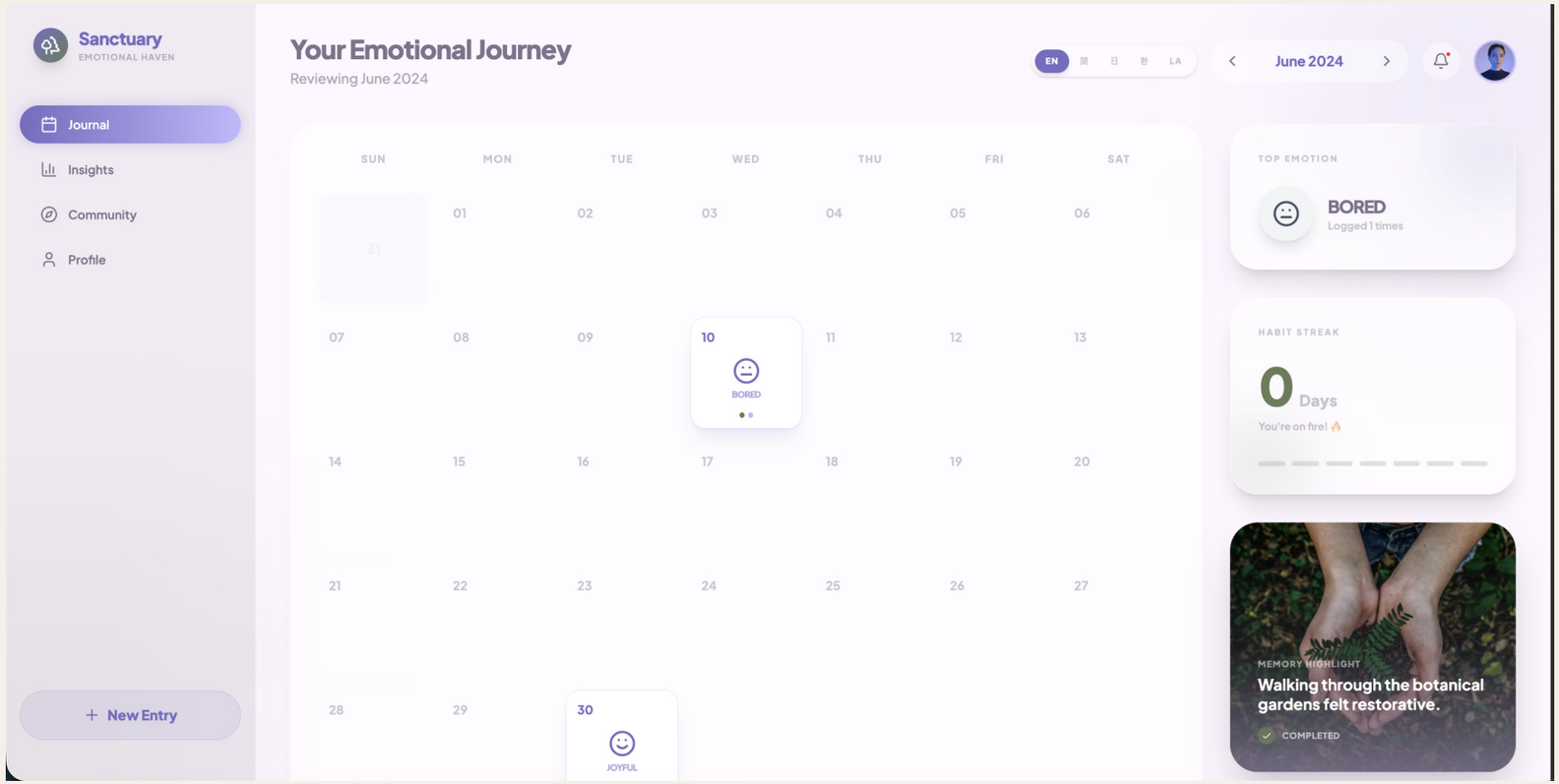
Pauses & revisions

Voids and layers register the unfolding of expression.

Can expression remain
when readable language disappears?

Sanctuary

A place to record a feeling.



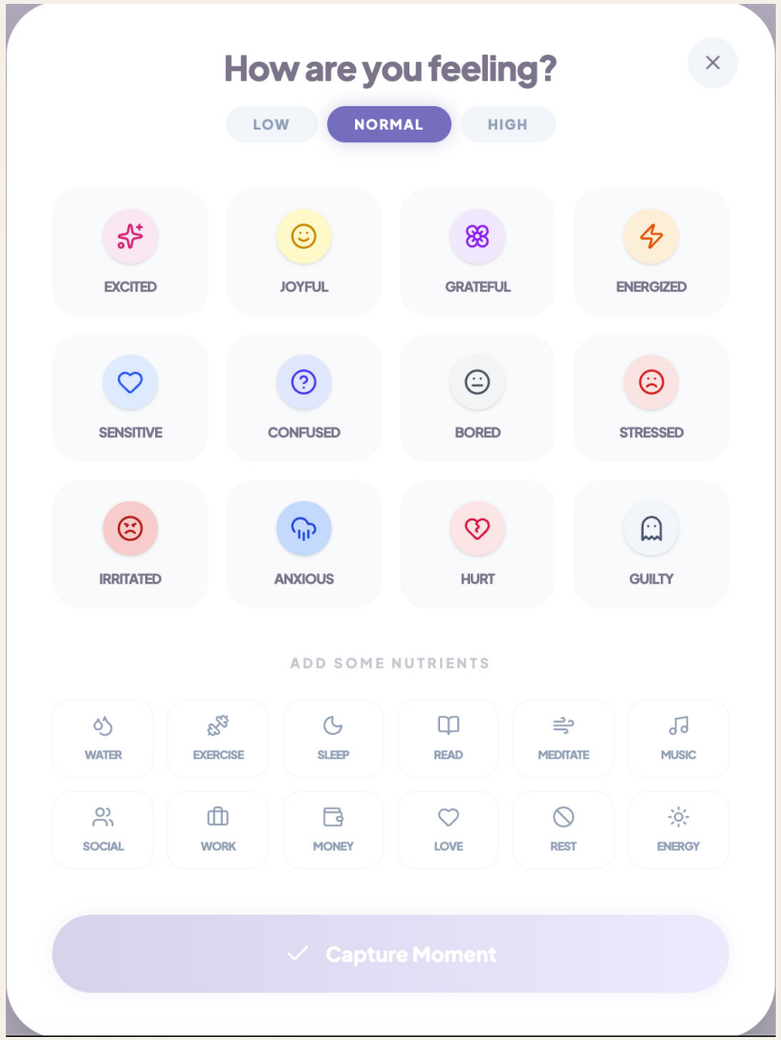
JOURNAL / ACTUAL WEB INTERFACE

Sanctuary brings emotion choices, everyday habits and a calendar into a web interface. I am exploring how a low-effort entry can make room for noticing and recording a feeling.

The interface also raises a question: what happens when a feeling does not fit the available choices?

OPEN WEB PROTOTYPE

sanctuary--emotion-coach.pages.dev



NEW ENTRY / WEB INTERFACE

A feeling is *more than a category.*

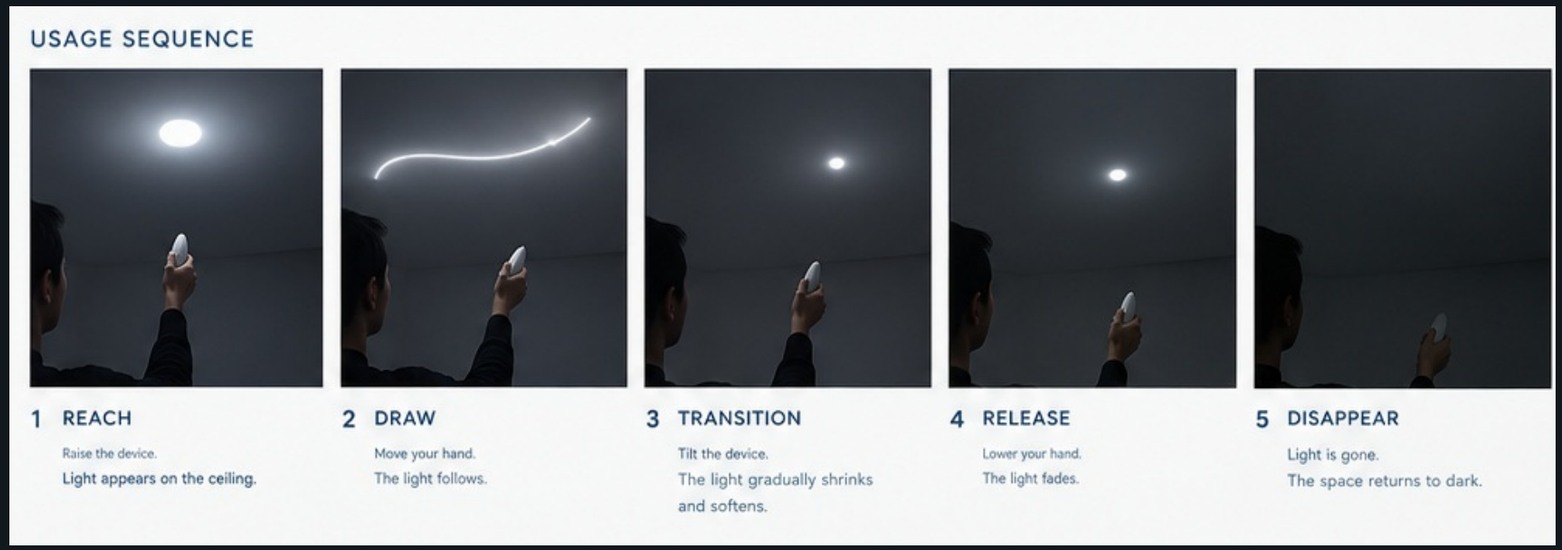
My early emotion diary interface explored choices, intensity and habits. The App was not published. Sanctuary now gives this area of exploration a web-based form.

Next, I want to explore how free writing or drawing could sit alongside selection, allowing a person to describe feelings in their own way.

EARLY INTERFACE / 2025



A gesture, *then darkness.*



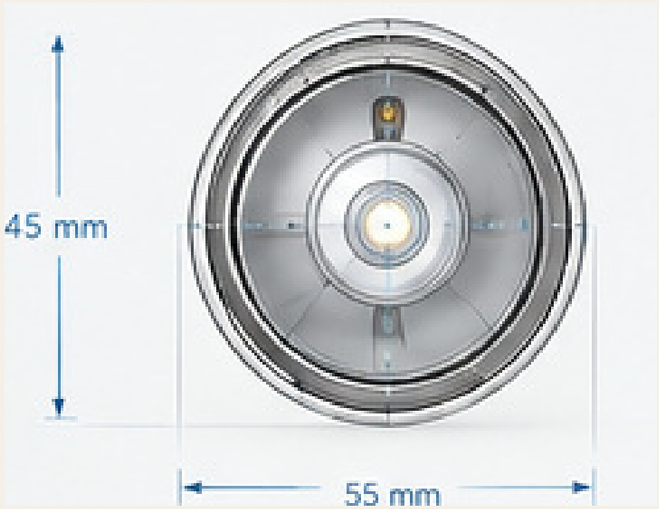
REACH / DRAW / TRANSITION / RELEASE / DISAPPEAR

Draw with Light explores a pre-sleep gesture: a hand moves a light across the ceiling, then lowers as the light fades. The experience is designed around reaching, tracing and letting go.

Held in the hand.



HAND-HELD EXTERIOR / DESIGN VIEW



FRONT / OPTICAL OPENING

The object needs to support the gesture without asking for a complicated sequence of actions. Its exterior and light opening are considered together with grip, orientation and the movement of the hand.

The next development task is to translate the intended fading of light into a simple, reliable mechanism.

Wave Troubles Goodbye

跟烦恼说拜拜



A small gesture,
an everyday ritual.

A ceramic condiment container turns shaking into a playful movement. When inverted, its arms move towards the head. The familiar household action becomes an encounter with a character.

I explore how a small physical action can bring humour into daily use.

Contentment

知足·咩咩

The sheep and blessing grass carry a wish for contentment. Bringing the grass towards the sheep turns cultural symbolism into a small action: observing, receiving and knowing enough.

A wearable ritual.



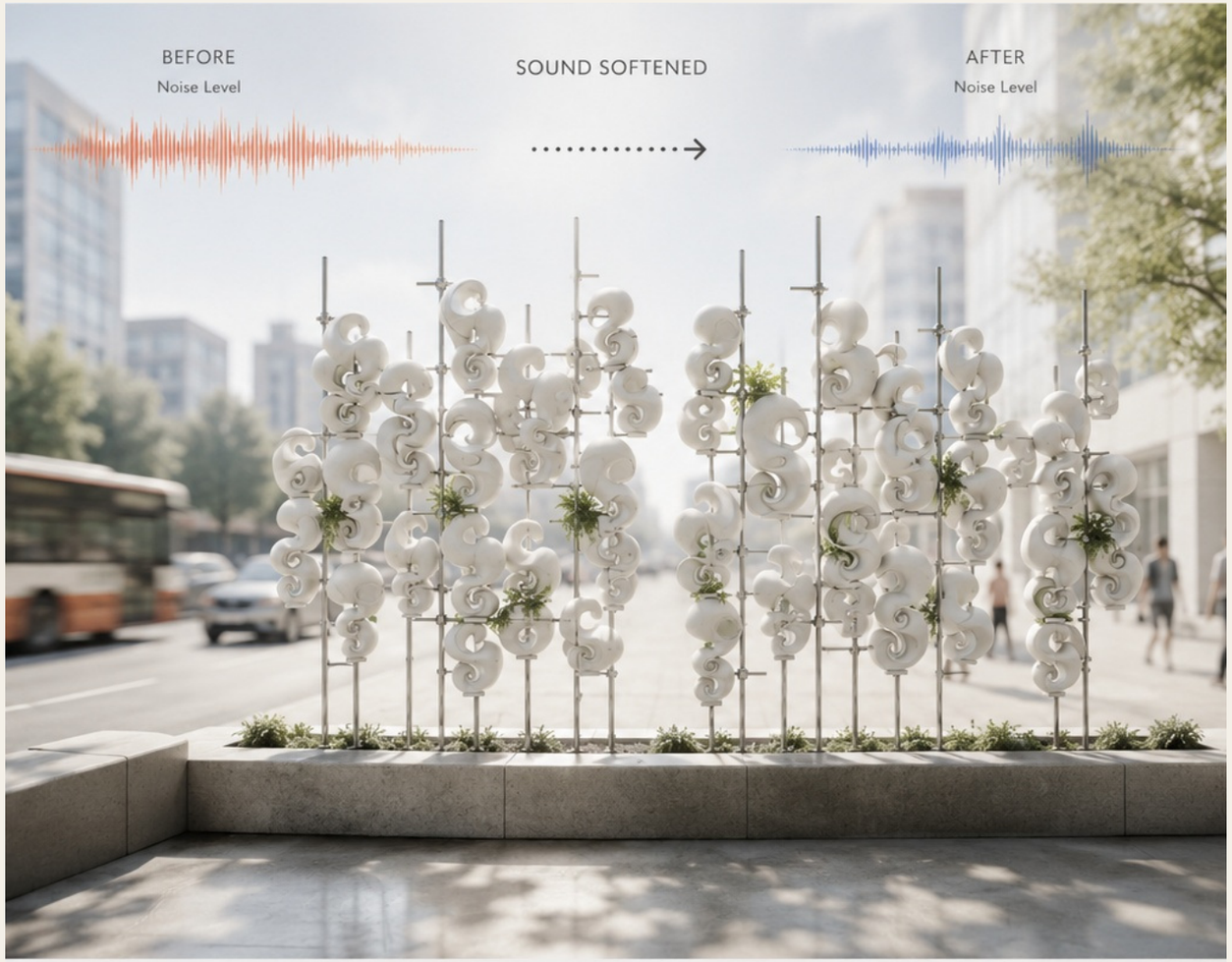
OBSERVE / CONTENT



Ceramic *Soundscape* Module

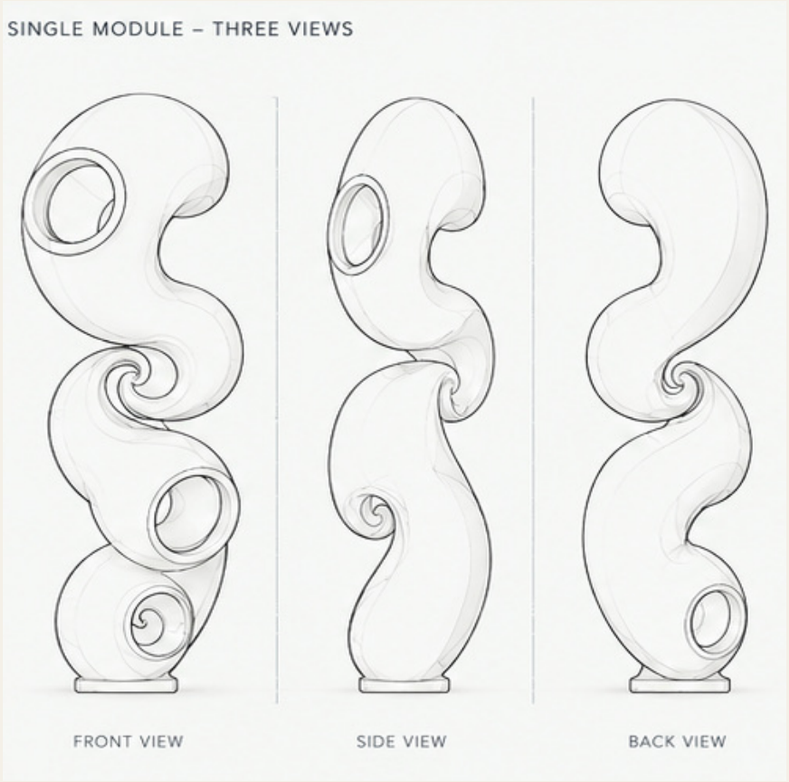
Filtering noise. Integrating living change.

This proposal explores filtering urban noise through hollow ceramic cavities, openings and porous surfaces to attenuate sound energy. Integrated vegetation brings growth and seasonal change, linking acoustic filtering with the changing vitality of plants. The aim is a quieter street soundscape shaped by both ceramic structure and living vegetation.

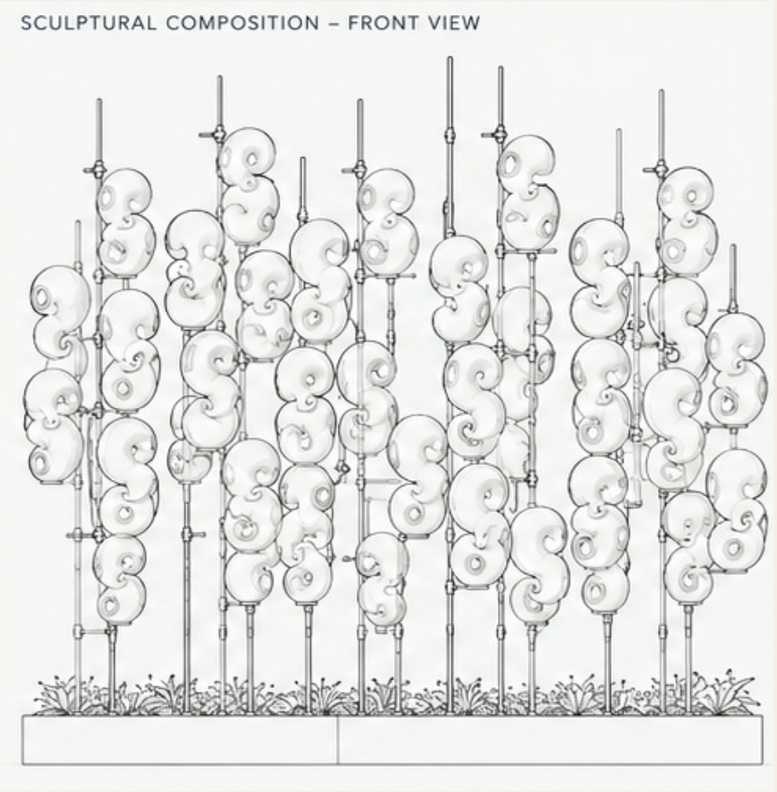


BRONZE / STREET LANDSCAPE DESIGN / 7TH SGADC

One module, *many encounters.*



MODULE / FRONT / SIDE / BACK



ASSEMBLY / FRONT VIEW

The hollow cavity, openings and porous surface are proposed as acoustic elements. Repetition turns the module into a spatial composition. Sound and plant growth remain part of the design question, alongside the visual rhythm of the arrangement.

Countenance

容颜

Two ceramic planes bring a figure into view. The profile and the rear form meet through overlap and an interval of space. Plants become part of the reading of the figure.

The empty space also shapes the face.



After Smile

余温

After Smile draws on the warmth that remains after people meet. A rising curve brings coloured elements into a small brooch, translating that lingering feeling into a form worn close to the body.

Created for the 2026 Shenzhen jewellery design exhibition, Together and Forward.



What an encounter leaves.

PHOTOGRAPH / FINISHED BROOCH



ON THE BODY / PHOTOGRAPH



A small object, *a lasting warmth.*

The worn piece brings the curve into the scale of the body. Material, colour and light change how the brooch is encountered at close range.

Cupping

Negative Pressure



Cupping is a traditional Chinese medical practice with a history of over two thousand years. Cups create suction at the skin's surface, leaving a temporary circular trace. Inspired by this encounter between pressure and the body, I translate the trace into optical jewellery: a ruby mark beneath a clear quartz dome explores compression, magnification and distortion.

AI expands visual possibilities.
Human judgement selects
the final direction.

BRONZE / HONG KONG AI ART CREATION COMPETITION

EXCELLENCE AWARD

LOVE NANJING

A jewellery exploration of cultural motifs and wearable form. The letters of LOVE organise references to flight, origin, heritage and enjoyment.

Culture carried through a small object.



8TH BAOQING JEWELLERY DESIGN COMPETITION

What connects *the work?*

Expression

TRACE and Sanctuary explore how expression can take form. Drawing and the six-panel story place this question within my own experience.

Gesture

Light, the condiment container and the sheep concept connect a physical action with an everyday encounter.

Material

Ceramics and jewellery bring environment, perception and memory into tangible forms.

My attention has moved towards how a person feels, expresses and gives meaning to an experience.

Why *art therapy?*

From designing an experience to supporting a person's expression.

My professional work taught me to organise space, materials and processes. Recent making and design explorations have led me to ask how people express feelings and how a material or interaction can make room for that expression.

When expression appears, how should I listen? How can the maker keep the space to interpret their own work? I want to understand the relationship between art-making, human relationships and the circumstances in which expression happens.

I am seeking a foundation in art therapy theory, ethics and assessment, alongside supervised practice and a continuing personal art practice. My design experience helps me organise media and experiences. Further training will help me understand how, and when, to support another person.

Selected achievements

TRACE 7th SGADC / Interaction Design	Bronze
Ceramic Soundscape Module 7th SGADC / Street Landscape Design	Bronze
Cupping | Negative Pressure Hong Kong AI Art Creation Competition	Bronze
LOVE NANJING 8th Baoqing Jewellery Design Competition	Excellence
After Smile 2026 Shenzhen Jewellery Design Exhibition	Shortlisted / Excellence
Countenance Rongchang Ceramics Competition	Shortlisted

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Art, expression and everyday experience.